TEA FACTORY DIGITAL

Supplier App: How It Works

Every rule the supplier app follows, screen by screen: the monthly bill and how it adds up, where its figures come from, advances, loans, manure, tea packets, savings, profile and bank changes, inquiries, notifications and settings. With worked examples.

For: factory owners, managers, office staff and the support team, so they can explain the app to suppliers.

As of: 28 October 2026. Figures in the examples are examples unless they are marked as the real galaboda slip.

Companion guide: "Admin Console: How It Works" explains the office side of every rule here.

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1. About the app

The app puts a supplier's monthly Green Leaf Account on their phone, and lets them ask the factory for an advance, a loan, manure or tea packets, change their savings or bank details, and send the office a message. Each factory has its own branded app with its own name, colours and logo.

> **What the app never does**
>
> - **It works out no figure of its own.** Every amount, limit and balance is the factory's, sent by the server. The app only shows it.
> - **It decides nothing.** Every request goes to the office; the factory approves or rejects it.
> - **It shows only the supplier's own records**, never another supplier's.
> - **It shows no figure before the auction.** A month without its rate shows blanks with a note, never "Rs. 0".

2. Signing in and keeping the app safe

- **Sign in with the supplier number and a password**: the bare number from "Sup. Code" on the slip (for example 5708), never an email.
- **The first password comes from the office.** At the first sign-in the app asks the supplier to choose their own. Keeping the office's password is offered as a real choice, not hidden. The answer is remembered for the account, so it is asked once, not on every phone.
- **Forgot password:** there is no email reset. The app shows the factory's telephone, email and hours; the office issues a new one-time password and ends the supplier's sessions on every phone.
- **Saved login** is kept only in the phone's secure keychain.
- **App PIN (4 digits)** and **fingerprint or face unlock**: offered once after the first sign-in. Fingerprint or face appears only when the phone has one set up and the factory allows it. It unlocks a saved session; it is not a password to the server.
- **Auto-lock** asks for the PIN after leaving the app: immediately, after 1 minute, after 5 minutes, or never. Only when a PIN is set. Answering a call or the app switcher does not count as leaving.
- **Coming back** opens where the supplier left off, behind the lock screen if a PIN is set.
- **Session ended:** if the server no longer accepts the sign-in, the app tries once to renew it; if that fails it says "Your session has ended. Please sign in again."

3. Finding your way around

Where	What
Bottom tabs	Account (the bill), Income, News, Profile (where the factory turns it on), Settings
Side menu (≡ in the header)	Savings, Request an advance, Request a loan, Request manure, Request tea packets, Inquiry. Each appears only if the factory runs it
Bell in the header	Everything the factory has sent, newest first, with unread marked

A first-time tour shows the main screens where the factory turns it on.

4. The Account tab: the monthly bill

- **Shows the newest published bill.** A bill the office is still checking, or one held back, is never shown. With no bill at all: "No bill is available yet."
- **Laid out like the printed slip**: factory name, telephone, registration number and month at the top; rate and kilos; amounts; the nine deductions; balance; carried-forward and savings panels; legal footer.
- **Daily supply:** a calendar of days 1 to 31 with the kilos supplied each day (blank for no leaf), and a small bar chart.
- **PDF:** the bill can be saved or shared as a PDF identical to the screen.
- **"Ask about this bill"** opens an inquiry about that month.
- **The labels are the slip's:** "Loan (instalment 3)" for the loan line (the PDF prints the slip's "Loans / Advance 3"), and "Other deductions" with the office's reason under it.
- **Loan balance** is the loan still owed; **Loan interest** is this month's interest in rupees.

5. How the bill adds up

> **The formula**
>
> ```
> Green leaf amount  = kilos × rate per kg
> Extra payment      = kilos × extra rate per kg
> Gross amount       = green leaf + extra + coins brought forward
> Balance amount     = gross − total of the nine deductions
> Paid               = balance (+ any savings withdrawal), rounded DOWN
>                      to the factory's payment unit (Rs. 1, 5 or 10)
> Coins carried fwd  = what is left below the unit, paid next month
> ```
>
> If the balance is below zero, nothing is paid and the shortfall is "Next month deb", which is next month's "Previous debts".

5.1 The real galaboda slip, July 2026 (supplier 5708)

```
509.5 kg × Rs. 222 = 113,109.00     extra 509.5 × 3 = 1,528.50
Coins brought forward 7.41
Gross        114,644.91
Deductions    46,418.00  (tea 1,298 · savings 5,095 · advance 40,000 · stamps 25)
Balance       68,226.91
Paid          68,220.00  (in tens)     coins carried 6.91 → August
```

5.2 The nine deductions

Line	What it is
Transport	Bringing the leaf from the estate, per kilo
Tea	Tea packets issued to the supplier
Savings	Savings per kg × the month's kilos
Loan	This month's loan instalment, with its number, plus interest if the factory charges it
Advance	An advance taken this month, deducted in full
Manure	This month's fertilizer instalment
Other deductions	Small amounts the office typed, with a reason
Stamps	Revenue stamp duty
Previous debts	What last month could not cover

The total is always the sum of the nine lines, and the app shows each line, including zeros.

5.3 Carried forward and savings

Panel line	Means
Next month deb	Debt carried into next month

Loan balance	The loan still owed
Manure balance	Fertilizer still owed
Loan interest	This month's interest charge in rupees
Savings: previous / this month / to date	The savings account before, this month's deduction, and the total

5.4 Bill number

The factory's number: the year of the bill's month and a serial that never resets, for example 2026210869, then 2027210870 in the new year.

6. Where the figures come from

The supplier's app looks the same whichever way the factory works. Behind it, the bill comes one of three ways:

The factory	The bill in the app is
Connects its own system to us (sync on)	The factory system's own bill, copied every hour
Keeps records in the console and imports its printed bills (galaboda)	The printed slip, stored exactly as printed
Keeps records in the console and has bills calculated there	Calculated by the console, and compared with the printed slip to the rupee before it is shown

So the app and the paper slip always agree

- The app never shows a bill the office has not published.
- A calculated bill that does not match the paper slip is **held back**; the supplier sees "No bill is available yet" for that month until it is fixed, compared again and released.
- A published bill is never changed. A mistake is corrected on the next month's bill.
- Everything approved in the app is also entered by the office in the factory's own system, which prints the slip and pays the money.

The full explanation of each mode, and every reason a figure can differ, is in the console guide, section 6.

7. This month so far Coming

Where the factory turns it on, a card above the bill shows the month whose bill is next:

- Kilos so far, days with leaf, the last supply date and a strip of daily bars.
- The advance, loan, manure and tea packets approved in the month.
- **No money**: the rate comes after the auction. The card says the payment comes with the bill.
- When the month ends the card says "Month ended, bill being prepared" and stays until that bill is published.
- **Which month:** the supplier's oldest month that still has an unpublished or held bill; otherwise the month after the factory's newest published month.

8. Income history

- **"Income" is the bill's gross amount** everywhere: the chart, the list and the credit limits.
- Three views: **Graph** (earnings or kilos per month across a year), **List** (each month's kilos, amount and paid; tap to open the bill), **Chart** (one month's deductions as a ring).
- A month without its rate shows its kilos and no money, with a "waiting for the auction" mark.
- The year's income statement can be saved as a PDF in the app's language.

9. Credit screens: how they all behave

Advance, loan, manure and tea packets each have a screen in the side menu. They work the same way:

1. **The rule first**, in one sentence, so the supplier knows the policy before asking.
2. **The working:** months of history, rate × kilos or the average, the multiplier, any cap, then the limit. Every figure is the factory's own. If the server sent too little to explain a figure, the limit is shown without a working rather than a wrong one.
3. **Waiting and retry:** while the figures load, the screen waits; if the call fails it offers a retry, never a placeholder "0".
4. **Blocked:** when a request cannot be made, there is **no form**. A message says why (table below).
5. **Checked as typed:** an amount above the limit is refused on the spot.
6. **History:** past requests with status (pending, approved, rejected, cancelled) and the office's note.
7. **Cancel:** a pending request can be cancelled. If the office decided first, the cancel is refused.
8. **One tap, one request:** tapping twice on a bad connection still sends one request.

Why there is no form	Screens
A request is already waiting for the office	Advance, loan, manure
A loan is still owed ("You can ask for a new loan or an advance once it is repaid")	Advance, loan
An advance taken is not yet deducted	Advance
Not enough settled months of history	Loan, manure
The manure balance has reached the limit	Manure
The factory has not set a price	Tea packets, a fertilizer type
This month's packets are used up	Tea packets

> **Asking is not getting**
>
> The factory may approve a different amount or term from the one asked for. It checks the limit again when it decides, because a month may have been published or a loan approved in between.

10. Request an advance

- **Cash against leaf already supplied this month.**
- **Limit** = last settled month's rate × this month's kilos so far. So it is 0 at the start of the month, and grows as leaf is weighed.
- **No history needed.**
- **Deducted in full on this month's bill**, even if it is more than the month earned; the rest becomes next month's debt.
- **Not offered** while an earlier advance is not yet deducted, or while any loan is owed.
- The screen's "Interest (advance and loan)" row is the newest bill's interest charge, mostly the loan's.

> **Example**
>
> September rate Rs. 200 a kg; 300 kg supplied so far in October. Limit: Rs. 60,000. The supplier asks for Rs. 40,000; once approved, it comes off the October bill in full.

11. Request a loan

- **Cash against a record of income.** Needs 6 settled months (the factory may set another number).
- **Limit** = 3 × the average gross of the last 6 settled months (default), capped where the factory sets a maximum.
- **The supplier chooses the term**: 3 to 12 monthly bills (default), as a row of choices. The amount per bill is shown under the choice as the amount is typed, so the supplier sees whether it is affordable.
- Each bill deducts the same instalment, numbered ("Loan (instalment 3)"), but never more than the factory's share of that month's gross; in a poor month the loan simply runs longer.
- **Interest** is the factory's: 0% unless set. Simple interest on the loan owed at the start of the month, taken on top of the instalment or inside it.
- **While a loan is owed**, neither a new loan nor an advance can be asked for. Manure is not affected.

> **Example**
>
> ```
> Last 6 settled months' gross average Rs. 80,000 → limit Rs. 240,000
> Asks Rs. 50,000 over 10 bills → Rs. 5,000 a bill
> With 1% interest on top: first bill deducts 5,500, loan balance 45,000
> With 1% inside the instalment: deducts 5,000, loan balance 45,500
> ```

12. Request manure

- **Fertilizer on credit.** Needs 6 settled months (default) and room under the limit.
- **Limit** = last settled month's rate × that month's kilos (default). What is already owed counts against it.
- The supplier picks the **type from the factory's list**, the **quantity in kilos** (25 to 400 in steps of 25, or any other figure), the **term** (1 to 6 bills by default) and delivery notes.
- **No amount is typed.** The factory prices it from its own list, by the bag, rounded up to whole bags.
- A type the factory has not priced cannot be sent.

> **Example**
>
> Urea in 50 kg bags at Rs. 9,000. The supplier asks for 60 kg: the store issues 2 bags, Rs. 18,000, recovered over the term chosen.

13. Request tea packets

- **The factory's own tea for the household. Not credit**: no history needed.
- **The cost is shown as the number is typed**, at the factory's packet price, and comes off the next bill's Tea line.
- **A monthly allowance** (default 10 packets); the screen shows what is left this month and hides the form when it is used up.
- **Delivery is a choice**: collect at the factory, or on the vehicle that collects the leaf.
- If the factory has set no price: "The factory has not set a price yet", and no form.

> **Example**
>
> 400 g packets at Rs. 1,200. Three packets: Rs. 3,600 on the next bill; 7 left for the month.

14. Savings

- **The savings account:** every month's savings in and withdrawals out, oldest first, with the balance after each, and a chart.
- **Savings per kg** is chosen from the factory's amounts. "No savings" (0) means the supplier is not saving.
- **Changing the amount** is a request to the factory: only approval changes it, one request at a time, and it starts from the next month not yet closed.
- **Withdrawals** are recorded by the office and approved by the manager, in the factory's withdrawal month (April by default). They are paid on the next bill, after the balance.
- Whether savings earn interest is the factory's decision; the app shows none until the factory posts it.

> **Example**
>
> Rs. 10 a kg, 509.5 kg in July: Rs. 5,095 saved. Previous 21,970 + 5,095 = 27,065 to date.

15. Profile, payment method and bank details

Field	When it changes
Name, phone, date of birth, email, avatar (10 pictures)	At once
Home address, estate address	Sent to the factory; changes only when approved
Payment method (cheque, bank transfer, cash)	Sent to the factory; changes only when approved
Bank, branch, account number (chosen from the factory's bank list)	Sent to the factory; changes only when approved
Savings per kg	Sent to the factory; changes only when approved
Collection point	Shown on Profile, read only; set by the factory

While a change waits

The app keeps showing the **current** payment method or bank account, with "pending approval" beside the requested one. Money keeps going to the approved account until the factory approves the change. Approved: the new value appears on the next refresh, from the next bill. Rejected: nothing changes, and the factory's note is shown. Only one pending request of each kind.

16. Inquiries

- Each inquiry is a **conversation**: the supplier's message, the office's replies and follow-ups, in one thread.
- A message is at most 2,000 characters.
- When the office closes it, the message box is replaced by a note; a new inquiry can be started.
- The list is newest first, with status: waiting, resolved or closed.

17. News, banners and notifications

- **News:** the factory's articles, newest first, pull down to refresh. An article with only English text still shows to a Sinhala or Tamil reader.
- **Banners:** a picture or panel on the way in, shown only during the factory's chosen dates. Its button opens a screen in the app, a website, a phone call or an email.
- **Notifications:** Monthly account ready, Request decided, Reply to your inquiry, Factory news (and Daily leaf weight, understood by the app but not sent yet).
- **The bell list is the factory's record**, not the phone's: a push that was swiped away or blocked is still in the list. Tapping one opens what it is about and marks it read.
- **Settings → Notifications:** a switch for each kind. The factory never sends a kind the supplier turned off.

18. Settings

Setting	Choices
Language	Sinhala (default), English, Tamil
Theme	Light (default) or dark, where the factory allows
Text size	Small, medium, large
Fingerprint / face	On or off, when the phone supports it and the login is saved
App PIN and auto-lock	Immediately, 1 minute, 5 minutes, never
Change password	Current, new and confirm
Notifications	One switch per kind
Profile and avatar	Section 15

19. Languages, dates and money

- Every word on every screen, the bill labels, month names and day names come from the app's language files: Sinhala, English and Tamil.
- Money: Rs. 1,234,567.50 in English, රු. in Sinhala, ரூ. in Tamil, always grouped in thousands with two decimals.
- Dates follow the language: Sinhala puts the year first (2026 ජූලි 10), English and Tamil the day first.
- Kilograms: kg, කි.ග්‍රෑ., கிலோ.
- The printed PDF bill follows the app's language too.

20. What each factory can switch on or off

Switch	When off, the app
Advances, loans, manure, tea packets	Has no menu row and no screen for it; the server refuses it too
Savings	Has no savings screen
News, promo banners, inquiries	Has no news feed, banners or inquiry screen
Notifications	Sends no push
Fingerprint / face, dark mode, auto-lock	Hides those settings
Onboarding tour, Profile tab	Hides the tour or the tab
This month so far	Hides the card

The factory also sets the credit rules, terms, interest, payment unit, tea packet price and allowance, fertilizer list, savings amounts, banks, languages, colours and logo. The app reads them at the next launch.

21. Privacy: what the app sends

- **Crash reports** (what broke, on which screen) and **usage counts** (which screens are used) help the team fix problems. A factory can turn either off.
- **Never sent:** the supplier's name, phone, ID number, bank account, or an exact amount. Amounts are sent only as a range (for example 5,000 to 25,000). The supplier is a code number, not a name.
- Personal and bank data are handled under Sri Lanka's Personal Data Protection Act No. 9 of 2022.

22. What works today and what is coming

Area	Status (28 October 2026)
Sign-in, PIN, fingerprint, auto-lock, bill, PDF, income history, credit and tea packet requests, savings, profile and change requests, inquiries, news, banners, notifications, settings, Profile tab	Working
Bills from galaboda's imported slips	Working
"This month so far"	Coming : waiting for the server
Daily leaf weight notification	Later
Attachments on inquiries	Not decided

23. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Green leaf	Tea leaf as plucked and delivered, weighed in kilograms
Supplier number	The number on the slip's "Sup. Code", used to sign in
Green Leaf Account	The monthly bill
Settled month	A month whose rate is in and whose bill is published
Gross amount (income)	Green leaf + extra + coins brought forward
Balance amount	Gross less deductions
Paid	The balance rounded down to the factory's payment unit
Coins brought / carried forward	The small part below the payment unit, paid next month
Next month deb	What a bill could not cover, carried to next month
Advance	Cash against this month's leaf, deducted in full this month
Loan	Cash against income history, repaid in instalments
Manure	Fertilizer on credit, repaid in instalments
Tea packets	The factory's tea for the household, on the next bill's Tea line
Collection point	Where the leaf is weighed
Change request	A change only the factory can approve: payment method, bank, savings, address